

CSSE 280 Homework 2 [4 hours]

Portfolio Website

In today's competitive job market, a well-crafted project portfolio serves as your professional showcase—demonstrating your skills, creativity, and technical expertise beyond what a traditional resume can convey. By turning your resume into an interactive HTML, CSS, and JS portfolio site, you're not only creating a digital version of your qualifications, but also showing your web development skills. This assignment gives you the chance to build a platform where potential employers can see your technical abilities, project experience, and professional background in an engaging way.

Your portfolio website can become your digital calling card that grows with your expertise and accomplishments. This project is more than just an assignment—it's an opportunity to think about how you present yourself professionally online. A well-designed site with good navigation, consistent styling, and interactive elements shows your technical knowledge alongside your attention to detail and design skills. As you create this digital showcase, remember that the skills you use here—from layout design to interactive features—are exactly what employers look for in today's tech-focused workplace.

Get Started with GitHub Pages

Follow these instructions to initially set up GitHub's pre-existing web server to host your professional portfolio on the Internet: <https://docs.github.com/en/pages/quickstart>.

Your repo name must follow the GitHub Pages naming scheme

You **must** name your GitHub repo with this **very precise repo name** with your **GitHub username** inserted: `username.github.io`

For example, if Sriram Mohan were to do this assignment, and his GitHub username were **rhith-mohan**, his repo *must* be named `rhith-mohan.github.io`

When you are done, you will be able to access the initial page of your portfolio in the browser with a URL like this with your username inserted: `http://username.github.io/`. If this very precise URL does not work for you, you almost assuredly named your repo wrong.

Make an index.html file to replace README.md

Deviating slightly from the Quickstart instructions, we will create a file named **index.html** to serve the landing page for our portfolio. After we commit and push this file, GitHub's web server will implicitly load this file when you connect to your web site without specifying any filename.

1. Create a file in your repo called **index.html**. Enter this starter code:

```
<html>
  <head>
    <title>TODO</title>
  </head>
  <body>
    <mark>TODO: implement your portfolio.</mark>
  </body>
</html>
```

2. Commit and push this starter file.
3. **Wait a few minutes** for your repository to finish processing its Actions to publish your website.
4. In your browser, load **your** personal GitHub Page **with no file name** in the URL, like this: `http://username.github.io/`
5. You should see this **highlighted** text in the browser since we are using the `mark` tag:

TODO: implement your portfolio.

If the browser does not show this text even after the Actions finished processing, then something is wrong; ask for help.

6. Replace the contents of your README.md with the link to your website for the graders:

Visit: <http://username.github.io/>

In general: web servers return the file named **index.html** or similar when no file name is requested in the URL. But, every web server is configured differently.

Requirements

For this assignment, you will take your resume and turn it into a publicly-facing HTML, CSS, and JavaScript portfolio site.

Three pages hosted on your GitHub Pages

You can have more, but you need at least these three:

1. **Main page (index.html)** including:
 - A photo of you (img tag). If you do not feel comfortable putting your picture online or using this as your real portfolio, you can use your favorite [HTTP Cat](#) photo instead.
 - Your name (in a heading tag)
2. **Resume page (resume.html)** that includes:
 - The technologies you know (as an HTML unordered list)
 - Your work experience (in a consistent format of your choice)
 - Your education experience (in a consistent format of your choice)
3. **Portfolio page (portfolio.html)** for your list of past projects. Each project includes:
 - Name of project
 - Short description of the project
 - Technology project was developed in
 - Link to the project (if applicable)*
 - A photo of a project

Navigation

All pages should have these elements in common:

- A site navbar (navigation bar on the top of every page)
 - Contains links to the main page, resume page, and portfolio page
- A site footer (text and links on the bottom of every page)
 - Contains links to any professional platforms (your Handshake or LinkedIn profiles)

For an A: figure out how to avoid duplicating this code across all three pages.

* In general, course assignments *should not* be put in public repositories, as this can provide your code to other students, which can be academic misconduct. Department policy is that your repositories should be hidden. There are some exceptions for course projects where you get to choose your own topic. In those cases, check with your instructor before making a repo like this public (and definitely wait until the course is over). However, this assignment CAN be public, and will be, even as you're working on it.

Interesting CSS and JavaScript

In addition to having the three pages, you need to introduce CSS and JavaScript to enrich them:

- One .css file, used by **all** pages, that defines the common color scheme and adds *useful layout* configuration.
- One .js file, used by either your resume or portfolio page, that adds *useful interactivity* to the page.

The goal with the *useful* requirements is to get you started on the mentality of “I saw someone do this. That means that I can do it. I’m going to figure it out, and I’m going to apply it to my portfolio!” **Cite** where you found the *idea* for the features that you implement in the source code.

Do not look at or copy other people’s code; the feature you are replicating must be **independently developed** by you.

Accessibility

- Meet 1.4.3 Contrast Minimum: <https://webaim.org/articles/contrast/>.
 - Check using <https://webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker/>
- Alt text for images and other media.
- Semantic HTML: at least one page section on each page:
 - <https://www.w3.org/WAI/tutorials/page-structure/sections/>
- Color-code links to show if they have been visited
 - See: zyBooks section on accessible links (a11y)
- WAVE evaluate your website when done!
 - <https://wave.webaim.org/>

Recommendations

An *impressive* portfolio website would go beyond the minimum amount of interactivity and design specifications that are required to fulfill the project requirements. This is your opportunity to demonstrate your skills and to set your portfolio apart from everyone else's.

Here are *some* ideas, but this list is not exhaustive, and no one idea below by itself is *impressive*:

- User Engagement
 - Single-page website with dynamically loaded contents
 - Show project and internship history as an interactive timeline
 - Include GitHub repository links and corresponding demo videos
- API Integration
 - [GitHub API](#): Fetch your GitHub projects with the API
 - Many others exist.

If you choose to go above and beyond the requirements, you can modify the base project to suit the more advanced features you choose to implement. For example, if you want to have the entire site be a single page with really interactive and dynamic navigation, that would justify ignoring the requirement that the site be spread across the three pages.

Submission Instructions

1. Make sure your README.md contains the URL to your website.
2. Make sure **everything** is committed and pushed.
3. Submit your GitHub repo to the Gradescope assignment for grading.